



Pencil Printer

XPencil printer designed by Hoyoung Lee of Yanko Design uses lead shavings as ink when printing, which can later be erased

Bronzing

An effect which imparts a metallic bronze-colored sheen to areas of the print based on the amount of ink in the printed area

Photo printer test

two sisters. The colours do not over saturate at any point.

Price: ₹5,595

Canon iP100

A lot of the ultra compact photo printers in the market are capable of doing only 4x6 inch print. Imagine carrying a portable printer that can do A4 prints just as good as it does 4x6 inch prints. Canon iP100 is the portable inkjet printer whose form factor is such that it can allow easy mobility. It's an upgraded version of the Canon iP90v.

The simple design philosophy of the other Canon iP series of printers is followed in the iP100 too. The printer that we got has a smooth silver matte finish all through out with glossy black side panels. A single black line on the top panel has the Canon logo and the model number. On the outer surface, there are no buttons or any kind of operational panel. Power connector port is present on the left hand side whereas the USB port is on the right hand side of the printer. This printer can run on batteries. It comes with an external battery which fits into a plastic slot. This slot has to be screwed on the rear side such that the battery ports are properly inserted in the space provided on the rear side.

Build quality of the printer is quite sturdy despite the small form factor. The same cannot be said for the tray quality though.



Canon iP100

The top panel opens up and acts as the feeder tray, whereas a front panel acts as the output collector tray. Due to the small height of the front panel, you will have to either collect each outputted paper manually or keep the printer with some desk space in front of it so that the output is manageable.

On opening the top panel, one comes across the two buttons viz: power and paper clearing button. The cartridges can be inserted by opening the panel alongside the buttons. Setting up the ink tanks should be done carefully as it is slightly different from the standard cartridge.

PictBridge is the only connectivity option present on the printer. It does not support printing from a memory card and also it does not have any network printing support.

Performance

Do not go by the size of the printer, as its performance is up there. It performed well in all the photo tests, coming out tops in most of them in terms of quality. However, one thing that was upsetting was the time it took to print a mixed document - 101 seconds. Specially when you compare this

with how quickly it prints the photographs.

It took 171 seconds for Photo 1 and 221 seconds for Photo 3, which was 20 to 30 seconds faster than the Canon iP3680.

₹15,695

Epson Stylus PHOTO TX700W

Epson printers are impressive to look at and Stylus Photo

TX700W does not disappoint on that count. Coming in the traditional black plastic body with a glossy finish with a matte finished top panel. The top portion of the all-in-one is the scanner section having a flatbed type of scanner. It uses as many as six ink cartridges



Epson Stylus PHOTO TX700W

namely CMYK, light magenta and light cyan. The front panel can be broadly divided into three sections viz: the feeder trays, the operational panel and the memory card and PictBridge slots. The design is quite interesting with the feeder as well as the output tray located on the front facing panel. Tray quality of the cassette is quite impressive and it has an additional tray on top to print CD covers. The trays have grey coloured movable locks for various size of papers ranging from 4x6 inches to A4 size.

Memory card slots are present on the right hand corner. There is a slot for SD/MSPro/xD card and another one for CF cards. A PictBridge port is present just beside the card slots, allowing you to print off a camera directly without then need of a computer.

The operational panel on the printer occupies the place of pride. The left hand portion comprises the power

button, a CD tray indicator and a four-way home button which allows you to directly switch modes from copying to printing to scanning. In the centre we have a 2.5-inch colour LCD screen. Navigating through the various menus on the screen is quite simple with the help of the navigation buttons beside the LCD screen. The operational panel can go from a front facing orientation to a top facing orientation by pressing the unlock button on its corner. There is a blue light which is on when

the printer is working. The all-in-one has lots of connectivity options like network printing, bluetooth, WiFi, memory cards and PictBridge. Setting up the WiFi functionality throws up many issues.

Performance

The TX700W is blazing fast as compared to the other printers. But one annoying aspect we discovered while printing was that when the photo prints were nearing the end, the glossy paper used to get stuck to the rollers and move sideways thus ruining the base of each photo print. Now whether this was the problem with this particular piece, we can't be sure. This affected its performance scores. It took 120, 126 and 140 seconds for Photo 1, Photo 2 and Photo 3 respectively. Photo 3 gave a good output giving crisp colours. Printing off a memory card also too under 75 seconds which was the fastest amongst all the printers.

Price: ₹13,999